# ASSEM MERZOUG

IT Support / Junior Systems Administrator

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## PROFILE

Systems-minded engineer moving into IT support and administration. I build, break and repair my own lab machines —Linux and Windows —and I write down what I changed and why. Comfortable at a terminal, methodical with tickets, and used to explaining a technical problem to someone who does not want the details.

## SKILLS

**Systems.** Linux (Debian/Ubuntu/Kali) administration, Windows Server 2022 and Windows 11, Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, SMB.

**Networking.** TCP/IP, routing, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, packet capture with Wireshark, service discovery with Nmap.

**Automation.** Python, Bash and PowerShell scripting; Vagrant and VirtualBox for reproducible machines; Git for versioning changes.

**Security.** Hardening basics —least privilege, service accounts, SSH key management, log review —learned by exploiting the mistakes in the field.

## SELECTED WORK

### Active Directory home lab

A two-machine domain (Windows Server 2022 domain controller, Windows 11 client) defined as code with Vagrant and PowerShell provisioning: forest creation, OUs, users and groups, SMB shares, and the common misconfigurations I test against.

### Fifteen HackTheBox machines

Linux and Windows hosts taken from an unauthenticated start to root or Domain Admin, and documented as reports —the same troubleshooting loop a support role runs, with the evidence attached.

### pdfsmith —report automation

A Python tool that produces formatted PDFs from structured data. Written to remove a repetitive manual step and keep output consistent.

## EDUCATION

### BSc Electrical Engineering

Systems, signals and control —the theory behind the networks and automation I work with day to day.

### MSc Automation & Systems Engineering —University of Palermo

In progress.

## CERTIFICATIONS IN PROGRESS

BSCP and CWES in progress, studied alongside the Active Directory and Linux lab work described above.